K.R. Manju Kashika

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Profile

Published researcher, with a Masters in Cognitive Neuroscience where I gained practical expertise in neuroimaging and stimulation techniques. Experienced in building relationships with diverse vulnerable populations to achieve impactful outcomes. Demonstrate expertise in both qualitative and quantitative research, multi-stakeholder coordination and complex operations, honed through large-scale research projects.

Education

MSc. Cognitive Neuroscience- University of Nottingham, UK (2024-2025) [First Class with Distinction]

- Fundamentals of functional imaging methods; Data analytics for Neuroimaging (**f/MRI, MATLAB, SPM**)
- Nottingham Advantage Award Modules- Communicating anatomy through art and Research Discovery
- Research Project- EEG study on Rule abstraction, Learning and Memory (**Fieldtrip, PsychoPy, M/EEG**)

BSc. Psychology- Stella Maris College, Chennai (2020-2023) [First Class, CGPA: 7.4/10]

- Abnormal Psychology - Case history taking, DSM and ICD
- Mixed method Thesis on **Burnout and Coping in Parents of Children with Chronic illness**

Research Experience

Indian Institute of Technology, Roorkee | Aug 2026 - Present

Research Intern

- Attempting different analysis on open access data from the Cogitate Consortium (2025)
- MEG data preprocessing and analysis using the FLUX MEG pipeline (MATLAB-ft & Python-MNE)

Schizophrenia Research Foundation (SCARF) | Jan - Aug 2024

Research Intern

- Assisted in psychosocial projects, primarily the Supported Employment Program for Persons with Mental Illness and the School based intervention using the Theatre Program for Prevention of Suicide
- Liaison between persons with severe mental illnesses, employers, caregivers and MHPs
- Trained in **literature reviews, focus group discussions, interviews,** designing survey and both qualitative and quantitative analyses.
- Worked with the Youth Mental Health department and the social media team- raising awareness

Unified Brain Health Care | Jan - Aug 2024

Research Intern

- Introduction to neurology and neuropsychology
- Study on Validation of MOCA Tamil 8.1, 8.2 and 8.3, and ACE-III Tamil
- Involved in Data collection from clinical and control group
- Clinical report writing on **cognition of Healthy Controls and Patients** with mild cognitive impairment

UNICEF and Tamil Nadu State Government| Sept- Dec 2023

Project and Research assistance

A state-wide project at the University of Madras (Dept. of Criminology), 'Activities to Strengthen the Child Protection Structures and Mechanisms in Tamil Nadu' in partnership with UNICEF

- Contributed to designing methods and tools, data entry and corresponding between officials for the project and the national conference on Child labour
- Assisted in organizing state-wide conference; Liaison with government and judiciary officials

Zion Media, SportsZion | Jun- Aug 2023

Jr. Tennis Writer, Content Writer

- Trained in sports journalism; Published 4 articles a day on happenings of professional tennis world

University of Chicago, Chicago Booth School of Business | Feb- Jun 2023
Research Assistant

Under Professor Bernd Wittenbrink, assisted on a social psychological study on face perceptions in the India and American population

- Recruitment and data collection among the Indian sample and expats
- Liaison with different academic, business and culture centres to reach the population of interest

Research Skills

- 'The mean project' [https://manjukashika.github.io/] to document and share open resources to learn neuroscientific research and application (Work in Progress)
- Other neuroscience Research projects
  - Impact of tDCS on working memory (Aug- Dec 2025)
  - Human gaze capacities btw. young and old adults (May 2026 - present)
- Basic data analytical skills for eyetracking, EEG and fMRI data (MATLAB, SPM, Fieldtrip, Python, MNE), EEG set up and data acquisition, Behavioural experiment designing (PsychoPy)
- Investigated diverse psychology and social research questions using research methods from case study, semi-structured interviews, FGDs, survey, scoping review and systematic review **(SwIM)**
- Teaching experience
  - **U&I Trust, India:** Volunteering for 3 hours a week to teach marginalized children (2023-2024)
  - **Teaching Assistant:** Delivering classroom support as a SEN and Primary Teaching Assistant across diverse school settings in Nottingham (Jan– Aug 2026)
  - **Support Worker** with Terra Consultancy: Supporting 6 undergraduate/postgraduate students with special needs, creating an accommodative learning environment (Oct 2024- Aug 2026)

Publications

1. ***The Ciência and Engenharia Science and Engineering Journal, March 2023 -*** The Relationship between Caregiver Burden and Spirituality in Primary Caregivers of Children with Chronic Illnesses
2. **Indian Journal of Applied Research, May 2024-** Case Study on Addressing Suicidal Ideation in a Young College Student Utilizing the Egan Model, Acceptance and Commitment Therapy (ACT), and Assessment and Management of Suicide Risk (AMSR)
3. ***Asian Journal of Psychiatry, April 2025-*** Examining the employment related factors among persons with mental illness: Findings from a cross-sectional study in Chennai, South India
4. ***Journal of Psychosocial Rehabilitation and Mental Health, May 2025-*** Employment and Persons with Mental Illness in India: A Scoping Review
5. ***Asian Journal of Psychiatry, September 2025-*** Developing and pilot testing a collaborative, locally contextualized supported employment program for persons with mental illness in Chennai, Tamil Nadu
6. **Journal of Psychosocial Rehabilitation and Mental Health, May 2026-** Employers' Knowledge, Attitude, and Willingness to Hire Persons with Mental Illness in South India: A Cross-Sectional Survey
7. **International Journal of Mental Health, August 2026-** A Systematic Review on Art-Based Interventions for Suicide Prevention in the Youth Population

Volunteering and Leadership

- Volunteered 3 hours a week at **Headway UK**, Retail raising funds to improve lives of people with **brain injury** (March – September 2025)
- Led and volunteered with U&I Trust, in programmes for education for **marginalized children** with a 95%+ attendance; Led the city-wide volunteer outreach vertical and nation-wide crowdfunding (2023- 2024)
- Volunteered with Golden Butterflies **Children's Palliative Care Trust, YRG Care** and **Parivardhan's Parkinson Trust**, primarily supporting caregivers of the lower socio-economic status (2021-2023)

Hobbies and interests

- Won Grand Prize award at the 2019 International Teenage Design & Art Award, Busan, Korea
- Performing and competing as a bharatnatyam and western dancer, since 2006; Head of the college dance team (2022); Participated in Kings of Gaana 2024 (KCL), London
- Awarded certificate of merit for 'the dedication to the Art of Bharatanatyam' in the 122nd year dance festival by Sri Parthasarathy Sabha, Chennai [Feb 2022]